

China Two-Wheeler Sector

Signs of recovery – time to revisit?

Equities

China

Automobiles

Companies seeing signs of recovery in recent data

We held a series of calls recently with two-wheeler companies. The following are our key takeaways. 1) Electric two-wheeler (e2W) volumes in China stabilised in Q226 with volumes flat after a 20% decline in Q126, pointing to a demand recovery. 2) OEMs are raising prices by 3-5% in April-May to pass on higher input costs, thus gross margins should hold up in Q226 or even exceed Q126 levels; there is no large-scale price war. 3) High oil and gas prices have driven strong export sales; sales of Ninebot's e-scooters in Europe and Yadea's e2Ws in ASEAN beat our estimates. 4) The industry continues to innovate, including Yadea's adoption of sodium batteries in two-wheelers. Overall, we like Ninebot (689009.CH) and Yadea (1585HK) most, both Buy rated, given their improved fundamentals and limited investor holdings. We also like CFMoto (603129.SH) and Loncin (603766.SH), both Buy rated, although there are some near-term headwinds, such as tariffs, FX and a decline in OEM demand.

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Ninebot: confidence in e2W business growth

Ninebot reiterated its confidence in achieving e2W volume sales of 5.5m in 2026, implying 30% YoY growth. It has mainly marketed e-motorcycles so far this year, but will add more e-bike models from mid-May. The company foresees a record-high peak season in Q326. In terms of pricing and margin, the company flagged a lower margin for e2W business (not the whole group) for full-year 2026 versus 2025. Ninebot believes margins bottomed in Q1, stabilised in Q2 and are likely to be higher in H226. Due to cost inflation, the company raised prices by up to Rmb100 in late April. For more details, see page 2.

Yadea: price hike of 3-5% in April

Yadea reiterated 2026 guidance: volume growth of 4%, ASP up 5-10% and gross margins flat. Yadea foresees two-wheeler demand normalising with flattish sales after the Q126 trough, flagging two-wheeler exports and three-wheeler sales in lower-tier cities as stronger than average. The company raised prices by 3-5% in April, passing on higher cost on plastics, copper and rare earth. The management has a volume sales target of 1m vehicles for 2026, driven by the new sodium battery technology, which it expects to achieve 6% penetration in its total 2W sales. Sodium batteries have a cost edge over lithium batteries when lithium carbonate prices are above Rmb150k per ton.

CFMoto: fundamentals solid, but uncertainties over and higher Rmb

Off-road-vehicle (ORV) demand is healthy in the US, with sales growth solid and the product mix improving, but it is partly offset by a higher Rmb and tariff. Meanwhile, 5-10% YoY growth in motorcycle exports represents a slow start in the management's view, but they expect faster growth from Q226. For Zeeho, the target of doubling sales is unchanged with more new e-bikes due to be launched in Q226.

Yadea (1585.HK, Buy)

2026 guidance reiterated: Yadea reiterated its sales volume guidance of 17m in 2026F and ASP hike of 5-10% given its mix upgrade, cost pass-through on the new national standard, and more battery sales. The company expects GPM to be flat YoY in 2026 and net profit per vehicle to increase to Rmb180-200 in 2026 from Rmb179 in 2025. The gross margin is improving QoQ in Q226, and the company expects this trend to continue in H226.

Price hike: Due to higher costs since March, Yadea has raised prices for its three-wheeler products by Rmb100-200, or 3-5%. In late April, the company raised prices on two-wheelers by Rmb50-100, or 3-5%.

Market demand has improved: In Q126, the company's sales declined c20% YoY, in line with the industry trend. Starting in April, Yadea's wholesale volume returned to an upward trend, although retail volume remains only flat YoY.

e-Mopeds pilot program: Yadea mentioned that Wuxi city is planning a pilot programme, which allows delivery riders to buy e-mopeds with special plates. E-mopeds have no restrictions on plastic usage, seat length and a top speed of 45-50 km/h. Yadea believes e-moped products are where true demand lies for more than 80% of end-consumers. In China, e-mopeds are categorised as motorcycles, which are regulated in most cities. Yadea believes this is a positive first towards officially allowing e-mopeds on roads in many cities.

Sodium battery sees meaningful adoption: Yadea expects to ship 1m units of sodium batteries in 2026, mainly equipped in its premium e-motorcycle products, such as Baisha 2. We estimate this equates 6-7% penetration of its 2W sales. The company highlights that its sodium battery leadership could be an edge when lithium carbonate prices remain elevated.

Oversea expansion on fast track: The company guided shipments of 500k units in 2026F vs 310k units in 2025. Yadea sees upside risk to guidance if high oil prices persist.

Ninebot (689009.SH, Buy)

Ninebot held a two-wheeler business conference call with investors on 13 May.

Moat around e2Ws business: Ninebot has set the e2W industry benchmark for other brands. While competitors may imitate its design and smart features, Ninebot believes its user experience remains unique. First, by leveraging intelligent electric vehicle integration, Ninebot anticipates a significant leap in product competitiveness in 2027, which should keep it ahead of the industry. Meanwhile, with comprehensive upgrades to after-sales service and a balanced distribution network by the end of 2026, Ninebot's core strengths create substantial barriers for competitors.

Industry demand: China e2W industry demand is showing clear signs of recovery from 26Q2. Ninebot believes industry demand will decline in H126 due to past demand becoming overextended, but expects demand to be flat or even grow slightly in H226.

Ninebot sales volume trend: Ninebot reiterated its e2W sales volume guidance of 5.5m in 2026F, expressing confidence in the target. For 2026 YTD, e-motorcycles have risen to account for the majority of its e2W sales. But from the end of May, with its full covered e-bikes launched in the market, Ninebot believes e-bikes sales will likely rise. Ninebot is confident that e-bikes can achieve good sales volume in Q326.

Overseas e2W: Ninebot conducted a thorough assessment of the Vietnam market in March 2026. Ninebot believes the Vietnam market is turning rapidly to e2W from ICE 2W and it can replicate its success in China's e2W market there. Ninebot also mentioned purchasing a motorcycle company in China, extending the company's edge into motorcycle design and manufacturing.

ASP and gross margin: The company raised prices of e2Ws at the end of April, but it flagged cost inflation in motors, tires and lamps. Thus, it foresees Q226 e2W margin being on par with the Q126 level and may improve in H226. For full-year 2026, the company foresees gross margin declining slightly from the 2025 level.

Product mix: Ninebot is launching more products in the Rmb3,500-4,000 segment, thus competing with incumbent brands to gain further market share. Ninebot said it will not move further into the Rmb3,000-3,500 segment without a cost edge.

CFMoto (603129.SH, Buy)

ORV: CFMoto notes ORV demand remains robust with U10 Pro monthly sales exceeding the 10,000 units sold in Q126, which suggests annual sales of more than 40,000 units. The Z10-4 model recorded 500–600 units in March and more than 1,000 in April. Q1 shipments increased 25% YoY, driven by a 40% YoY rise in North American sales partially offset by a slight decline in Europe. Due to US tariffs, gross margins for ORVs are higher in Europe than in the US. US inventory covers 4–5 months, and CFMoto is keeping its ORV prices in the US unchanged for now.

Motorcycles: Competition in the domestic motorcycle market is intensifying and the company has maintained a strong performance with the CFMoto 500SR. Export orders are improving, with Q1 showing typical off-season patterns. The company expects full-year motorcycle export growth of 20–30%. Europe leads in export volume, followed by North America, South America and Asia. The company expects gross margins and average selling prices to increase. Meanwhile, CFMoto notes all overseas transactions are settled in US dollars, suggesting Rmb appreciation is a headwind in Q226.

Zeeho: From January to April 2026, Zeeho sales focused on electric motorcycles, accounting for more than 80% of its sales. In the coming months, the focus will shift to e-bikes. CFMoto reiterated its Zeeho sales target of 1.15m units. The company expects Zeeho losses to narrow in 2026, although breakeven is not as likely as was signalled in prior estimates.

Zongshen Power (001696.SZ, NR)

Relationship with Loncin: According to public information, Zongshen Power holds a 48.29% equity interest in Zongshen Xinzhaizao, which has 24.55% of Loncin (603766.SH) total share capital. The relationship creates competition between the two companies under the same ultimate controller, Zongshen Group. As such, Loncin and Zongshen are planning an asset swap with Loncin transferring its general motor business to Zongshen in exchange for the motorcycle engine business of Zongshen.

General Motor business: According to Zongshen, it manufactures many kinds of general motor whole products including ride-on mowers and home power generators. Currently, it is a pure OEM selling to many well-known US brands, including Generac and Westinghouse. In emerging markets, such as South America, the company plans to establish its own brand to improve profit margins. With the acquisition of Loncin's general motor business, the company targets to become a worldwide leader in the general motor sector in the medium to long term. In 2025, the company sold c5m units of general power engines with an ASP of around Rmb9,000. The company also plans to expand its manufacturing footprint globally. It now has four factories in Vietnam and has benefitted when US tariff blocked other Chinese suppliers in 2025.

Aerospace engine: Zongshen's aerospace engine business contributed about Rmb200m revenue in 2025. The business has been under development for more than 10 years, since 2014, and is on a fast growth track.

NEV business: The company also engages in the NEV business, including ESS and hydrogen fuel cells, although this remained a small-scale operation in 2025.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

For the two-wheeler sector, upside risks include: 1) severe congestion in Chinese cities driving a further rise in adoption of electric two-wheelers (ETWs); and 2) industry consolidation accelerating, with small- and medium-sized firms rapidly exiting the market and leaders continuing to gain market share. Downside risks include: 1) the 2024 new national standards giving rise to a shift in transport preference back to buses and subways from ETWs, causing industry sales volume to decline; and 2) the industry landscape deteriorating on fierce price competition.

Ninebot: We value the company using a PE multiple. Downside risks include: 1) a shift in transport preference back to buses and subways from electric two-wheelers, causing industry sales volume to decline; 2) a deteriorating industry landscape with fierce price competition; 3) expansion of new businesses such as robot mowers and off-road vehicles missing expectations. Upside risks include: 1) increasing demand for high-end e-bikes; 2) right-of-way relaxations in more cities, driving e-motorcycle demand; 3) expansion of new businesses such as robot mowers and off-road vehicles exceeding expectations.

Yadea Group: We value the company using a PE multiple. Downside risks include: 1) the 2024 new national standards giving rise to a shift in transport preference back to buses and subways from ETWs, causing industry sales volume to decline; 2) the industry landscape deteriorating on fierce price competition; 3) lower-than-expected new business volume from the after-battery market; 4) slower-than-expected promotion of sodium-ion batteries; and 5) export headwinds from slower-than-expected expansion in the Southeast Asian market.

CFMoto Power: We value the company using a DCF methodology. For the large-displacement motorcycle industry, upside risks include: 1) loosening of motorcycle bans/restrictions in Chinese cities leading to higher-than-expected adoption of large-displacement motorcycles and rapid demand growth; and 2) a decline in raw material costs. Downside risks include: 1) less-than-expected loosening of motorcycle bans/restrictions policies in Chinese cities, leading to lower-than-expected adoption of large-displacement motorcycles and slow demand growth; and 2) pressure from rising raw material costs. For the company, downside risks include: 1) slower-than-expected launch and market acceptance of its large-displacement motorcycle products in China, affecting its motorcycle sales volume and ASP; 2) failure to obtain export tariff exemptions for its four-wheeler products, impacting its export volume and margins; and 3) frequent product safety incidents that dampen sales volume. Upside risks include: 1) greater-than-expected market acceptance of its large-displacement motorcycle products in China; and 2) obtaining tariff exemptions for its four-wheeler products, alongside stronger-than-expected demand from overseas.

We value Loncin Motor using PE. Downside risks for Loncin include: 1) its large-displacement motorcycle products falling short of expectations in launch pace and market recognition terms, impacting the company's motorcycle sales volume and ASP; and 2) frequent occurrence of safety incidents for its products, denting sales volume. Upside risks include: 1) Loncin's large-displacement motorcycle products proving more popular than expected; and 2) expansion of its four wheeler offerings overseas beating expectations.

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Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	54%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 31 March 2026.

1:Percentage of companies under coverage globally within the 12-month rating category.

2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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Company Disclosures

Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Loncin Motor	603766.SS	Buy	Rmb14.83	14 May 2026
Ninebot Limited	689009.SS	Buy	Rmb41.01	14 May 2026
Yadea Group ²⁸	1585.HK	Buy	HK\$11.96	14 May 2026
Zhejiang CFMoto Power	603129.SS	Buy	Rmb256.55	14 May 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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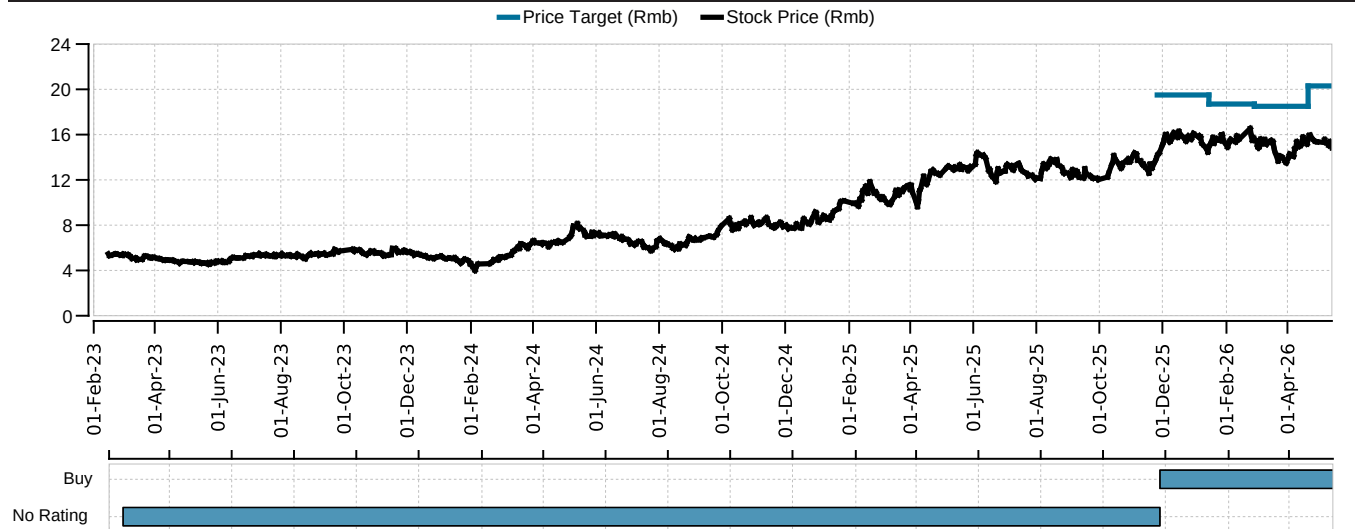
Ninebot Limited (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-02-14	34.67	-	No Rating
2025-01-09	50.86	52.00	Neutral
2025-04-21	55.80	73.00	Buy
2025-08-01	58.64	81.00	Buy
2026-01-30	51.76	75.00	Buy
2026-04-29	45.50	73.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 14-May-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

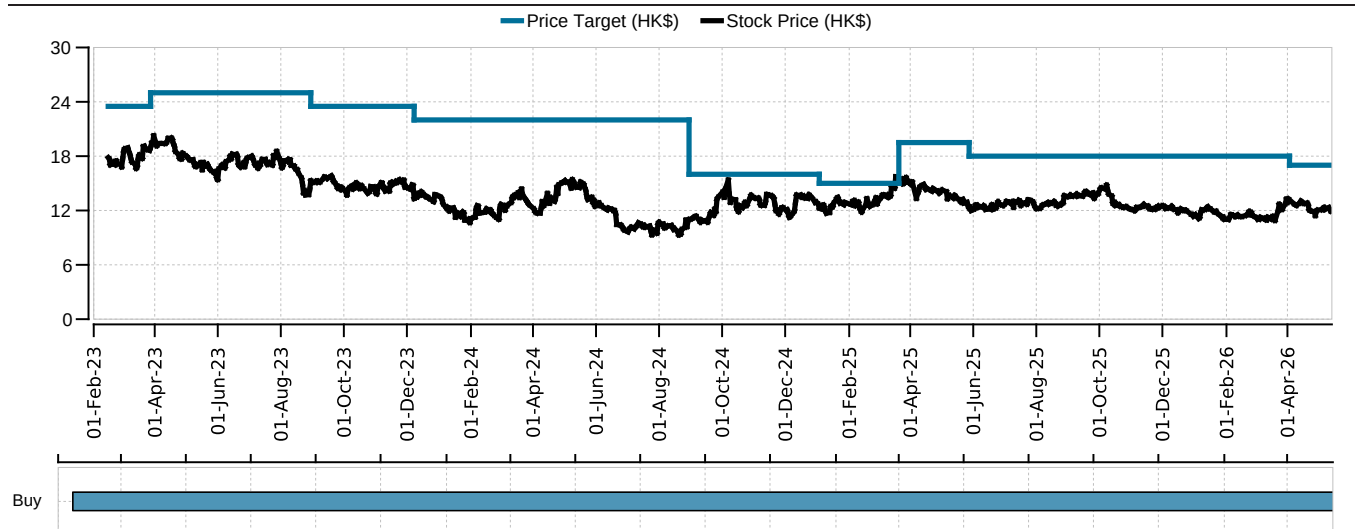
Loncin Motor (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-02-14	5.52	-	No Rating
2025-11-25	13.86	19.50	Buy
2026-01-14	14.45	18.70	Buy
2026-02-27	15.75	18.50	Buy
2026-04-20	15.16	20.30	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 14-May-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

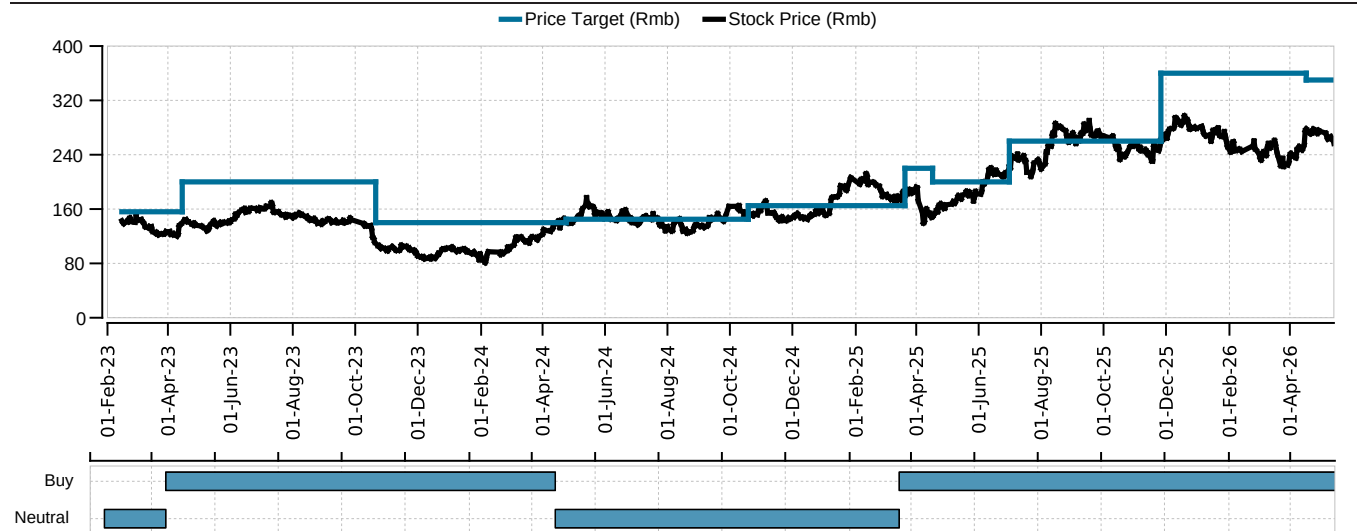
Yadea Group (HK\$)



Date	Stock Price (HK\$)	Price Target (HK\$)	Rating
2023-02-14	18.16	23.50	Buy
2023-03-27	18.64	25.00	Buy
2023-08-29	14.32	23.50	Buy
2023-12-07	14.76	22.00	Buy
2024-08-29	10.80	16.00	Buy
2025-01-02	12.70	15.00	Buy
2025-03-20	15.76	19.50	Buy
2025-05-27	12.50	18.00	Buy
2026-04-02	13.27	17.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 14-May-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Zhejiang CFMoto Power (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-02-14	137.60	156.00	Neutral
2023-04-14	137.85	200.00	Buy
2023-10-20	111.07	140.00	Buy
2024-04-23	142.48	145.00	Neutral
2024-10-18	155.38	165.00	Neutral
2025-03-20	184.10	220.00	Buy
2025-04-16	147.85	200.00	Buy
2025-06-30	216.50	260.00	Buy
2025-11-25	252.31	360.00	Buy
2026-04-16	275.19	350.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 14-May-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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